

C2-09 Capstone Submission & Evaluation Rubric

Standards are visible; answers are not

PASS PHILOSOPHY

Do not average away a critical failure. Grain integrity, validation/reconciliation, definition integrity, privacy/security, truthfulness and independent reasoning are hard floors. A high visual/presentation score cannot compensate for a wrong analytical system.

EVIDENCE SCALE

0 Missing; 1 guided/incomplete; 2 independent basic; 3 independent professional; 4 can review/mentor. CAP mastery normally requires level 3 on its core competency plus saved validation/limitation/explain-back/changed retry.

RUBRIC AREAS

Requirements/decision contract; source/grain understanding; SQL/extraction; transformation/reproducibility; model/DAX; investigation/uncertainty; report/decision usability; validation/quality; executive recommendation; documentation/handover; defense; career evidence truthfulness.

Critical floors

Any unresolved item below blocks capstone release

DATA / MODEL

Facts mixed at incompatible grains; higher-grain Target/Marketing multiplied; dimension key/cardinality unresolved; report totals cannot reconcile; supplied raw controls altered/ignored; quality trap silently deleted.

ANALYSIS / COMMUNICATION

Known metric conflict silently resolved; correlation framed as proven cause; material limitation omitted; recommendation lacks executable action/owner/measure; synthetic project described as employer/production impact.

PROCESS / INTEGRITY

Protected review opened before saved attempt; solved output copied; raw sources overwritten; no reproducible handover; security/privacy assumptions ignored; reviewer cannot trace headline figures to evidence IDs.

Evidence expected by CAP stage

Use this as a checklist, not a model answer

CAP1-CAP5

Decision contract + metric definitions; source/grain/quality register + raw controls; grain-safe SQL/control queries; transformation/tool-choice + exception evidence; model diagram/measure/date-role/relationship controls.

CAP6-CAP10

O//R investigation + alternatives; decision-facing report + interaction/accessibility/security assumptions; 10+ independent controls + publication rule; 120/80-word executive brief; handover README/dictionaries/lineage/runbook/known issues.

CAP11-CAP14

Technical defense with alternatives/failures/production reflection; truthful interview stories; evidence-backed promotion case; external job requirement/evidence/gap map and public-safe portfolio story.

Evaluation record

Manual evidence review - no percentage gaming

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Can another analyst reproduce the project? Can every business headline be reconciled? Can the learner explain why each fact remains separate? Can they defend a failed/alternative design? Can they distinguish project proof from production/workplace claims? Are changed retries genuinely changed?

RESULT

CAPSTONE MASTERED only when CAP1-CAP14 are individually mastered and no critical floor remains unresolved. Otherwise route the failed competencies to targeted repair and changed evidence; do not restart strong areas.

NEXT

Capstone mastery permits Final Gate A. It does not by itself mark C2A complete, PL-300 ready, promoted, employed or Data Engineer ready.